



User Guide

Everything you can do with Atelier: notes, Word documents, PDFs, images and spreadsheets — in one place, on your own computer.

Version 0.4 **Updated** August 2026 **Platforms** Windows · macOS

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What Atelier is

Atelier is your local workspace: open, edit and organise your everyday files without sending anything to the internet.

Most apps today live in the cloud: your documents sit on someone else's servers, and you need an account and a connection. Atelier makes the opposite choice. **Your files stay files**, inside a folder on your own disk that you choose. No account, no forced sync, no subscriptions: if you ever uninstall Atelier, your documents are still there, ready to open with any other program.

The vault

The **vault** is simply the folder that holds your work. It can be a brand-new folder or one you already use — your documents folder, or a folder synced by OneDrive/Dropbox (syncing, if you want it, stays your choice with your own tools). Inside the vault Atelier only keeps a small service folder, `.atelier`, with settings and the trash.

You can have **several vaults** — say "Work" and "Personal" — and switch between them. Each Atelier window opens one vault.

One app, many formats

Notes — .md

Markdown notes with Obsidian-style hybrid writing, editable tables and links between notes.

Documents — .docx

An editor with real A4 pages, compatible with Word and Google Docs files.

PDF

Reading, search, highlighter, fillable forms and OCR for scans.

Images — png, jpg, webp...

Viewing and annotations: pen, arrows, shapes, text.

Spreadsheets — .xlsx, .csv

An Excel-faithful grid with a formula engine and 342 functions.

Presentations — .pptx

Faithful slide viewer with thumbnails and a full-screen Present mode that plays the file's transitions.

First steps

Opening or creating a vault

On first launch Atelier asks where you want to work:

- **Create a vault** — choose where to create a new folder;
- **Open a folder** — turn an existing folder into a vault: the files it contains appear straight away in the Explorer.

From the next launch you get the **list of known vaults**: one click and you're in. If you open a second Atelier window, the vault picker appears again — so you can keep two vaults open side by side.

The window

The interface is divided into four areas, top to bottom:

AREA	WHAT IT HOLDS
Title bar	On the left, the button that shows/hides the Explorer and the logo. In the middle you can drag the window (double click = maximise). On the right, the Standard / Developer switch and the minimise · maximise · close controls. If you close with unsaved changes, Atelier asks first.
Tab row	One tab per open file; on the right, the folder path of the active file.
Explorer (left)	The tree of folders and files in your vault.
Workspace	The open file, with its toolbar.

The Explorer

- **Folders** have a chevron that rotates when you open them.
- **Files** show a clean name and a **badge with the extension** (PDF, XLSX, JPG...); Markdown notes, the home format, carry no badge.
- **Drag** a file onto a folder to move it.
- Resize it by **dragging its right edge**; the button at the top left of the title bar hides it entirely when you want maximum room for content.

Tabs

- Every open file becomes a **tab**: click to switch between files.
- The **amber dot** on a tab flags unsaved changes.
- Close with the **X** or a **middle click** (the mouse wheel).
- **Reorder** tabs by dragging them: a blue line shows where the tab will land.

Tip. Links between notes, search results and converted files all open in a tab: you never lose what you were working on.

CHAPTER 03

Working with files

Creating a new file

From the Explorer's **New file** button pick the type (Markdown note, Word document, spreadsheet...), give it a name, and Atelier creates it in the selected folder and opens it immediately.

Bringing in existing files

The vault is a normal folder: you can copy files into it from File Explorer / Finder and they show up in the Explorer. Any .docx, .xlsx, .pdf or image created by other apps opens as-is.

Searching

Two searches, always at hand:

- **Ctrl** + **P** — **search by name**: type a few letters of the file name, hit **Enter** and it opens.
- **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **F** — **global content search**: find a word or phrase *inside* the files of the whole vault and jump straight to the match.

Renaming, moving, deleting

All of it happens in the Explorer. Deleting never destroys anything: the file goes to the **vault's Trash**, where you can recover it. Open tabs follow their files: rename or move a file and its tab updates by itself.

Converting between formats

Whenever a file can be transformed, its toolbar shows a **Convert** button. Conversion **creates a new file next to the original** (the original is never touched) and opens it right away.

FROM...	...YOU CAN GET
Markdown	Word (.docx) · PDF · HTML page · plain text
Word	PDF · Markdown · HTML page · plain text
PDF	Word (text only) · PNG images (one per page) · plain text
Image	PDF · PNG · JPEG · WebP
Excel	CSV (first sheet)
CSV	Excel (.xlsx) · Markdown
Text (.txt)	Markdown

CHAPTER 04

Notes (Markdown)

Atelier's home format: plain-text files that stay yours forever, with writing that turns beautiful to read as you type it.

The three views

At the top you choose how to see the note:

VIEW	WHEN TO USE IT
Editor	The Markdown source with syntax highlighting. For full control over the text.
Hybrid	The perfect middle ground, Obsidian-style: you write Markdown and the line turns into the result the moment you leave it. Big headings, real bold, real tables.
Reading	Only the final result, typeset with serif headings. For reading and presenting.

What you can write

- **Headings** (`# Title`), **bold**, *italic*, bulleted and numbered lists, quotes, dividers.
- **Editable tables**: in the Hybrid view Markdown tables become real tables — click a cell and type, and use the menu to add or remove rows and columns. No more aligning dashes by hand.
- **Links between notes** with `[[note name]]` : click to jump; the note opens in its own tab.
- **Callouts** — coloured boxes for notes and warnings (`> [!note]`).
- **Code blocks** with highlighting for dozens of languages.
- **Images** embedded in the note.

Context menu

Right-click in the editor for quick actions on the selected text: formatting, links and table operations.

Why Markdown? It's plain text: readable with any program, versionable, searchable, incorruptible. Today's notes will open identical twenty years from now.

CHAPTER 05

Word documents

An editor with real pages: what you see on screen is the A4 sheet you'll print, without opening Word.

Compatibility

Atelier opens .docx files created by Microsoft Word, Google Docs and LibreOffice, and saves them still compatible: the file remains a normal .docx you can open anywhere.

Writing and formatting

- **Character**: bold, italic, underline, text colour, highlight, font family, superscript and subscript.
- **Paragraph**: headings, alignment (left/centre/right/justified), bulleted and numbered lists, task lists with checkboxes.
- **Tables** with row and column management.
- **Images** inside the document, from the dedicated button.

Document settings

The **Settings** panel controls page format and margins. With the **continuous view** pages scroll without breaks — great for long-form writing; switch it off to see the real page breaks.

Saving

The **Save** button (highlighted with the blue gradient) writes the .docx. The amber dot on the tab reminds you when changes are pending.

CHAPTER 06

PDF

Read, find, highlight and fill in — with an automatic safety net before any change.

Reading and search

Zoom, smooth page-by-page scrolling and **text search** from the Search button. The **Info** panel shows the metadata (title, author, page count...).

Highlighter

Turn on the highlighter, pick a colour from the palette and sweep over the text: highlights are **saved inside the PDF**, so you'll find them again in any other reader.

On the first change Atelier automatically creates a **backup copy** (`.bak`) next to the file: the original is always recoverable.

Fillable forms

If the PDF contains a form (text fields, checkboxes...), the fields are highlighted and **can be filled in directly**; saving writes the values into the file, ready to send.

OCR — text from scans

A scanned PDF is just a picture: with **OCR** Atelier extracts its text so you can copy and reuse it. Everything happens on your computer — no document is uploaded anywhere.

Images

Look closely and explain with a mark: arrows, highlights and notes drawn straight onto the image.

Viewing

Zoom with the wheel and **pan** with the hand tool to move around a zoomed-in image. The **Info** panel shows the file's size and details.

Annotations

The toolbar has everything you need to mark up an image:

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
Select	Pick up an element you've already drawn: you can move, resize or delete it with the blue handles.
Pen 1 and 2	Freehand drawing in two thicknesses, any colour.
Arrow	Straight arrows to point at things.
Shapes	Rectangles and ellipses, to frame an area.
Text	Text labels on the image.
Eraser	Removes individual drawn elements.

Until you press **Apply**, annotations stay editable: adjust them, move them, change them. Apply merges them into the image and saves.

Quality preserved

Saving **keeps the file's original DPI**: a print-quality image stays print-quality. And with **OCR** you can extract photographed text (signs, documents, whiteboards).

Spreadsheets

If you know Excel, you already know Atelier: same logic, same keys, same formulas. Only the colours are different.

Your files, intact

Atelier opens .xlsx and .csv files and **preserves them entirely**: everything the file contains — even things Atelier doesn't display yet, like charts — survives saving. The sheet you reopen in Excel is the one you saved.

The grid

- Real column widths and row heights, **merged cells**, colours, borders and number formats as in the original file.
- **Multiple sheets** with tabs at the bottom: add, rename, delete (with confirmation).
- **Thousands of rows without slowdown**: the grid draws only what you see.
- **Freeze panes** to pin headers and first columns (from the right-click menu; the setting is written into the file).
- **Filters** on headers, hidden rows respected.
- **The file's charts are drawn** where they belong on the sheet: bars, lines, areas, pies and scatter, with the original colours and titles. **They follow the data**: edit a cell and the chart updates at once. (Charts are read and drawn, not authored in Atelier; they stay untouched in the file.)
- **Data validation**: cells with a list of allowed values show the arrow and drop-down menu, just like Excel — even when the list lives on another sheet.
- The **status bar** shows Sum, Average and Count for the selection — just like Excel.

Moving and selecting

- Click a cell = **selection**; drag to select a range; **Shift** +click to extend.
- Click the **row numbers or column letters** to select whole rows/columns; drag across the headers to select several.
- **Ctrl** +arrows jumps to the edge of the data, **Ctrl** + **F** finds in the sheet.

Typing into cells

- Select and **type**: the content is replaced (like Excel). To **edit** the existing content use **F2** or double click.
- **Enter** confirms and moves down, **Tab** confirms and moves right, **Esc** cancels.
- Typed dates (**12/5**), times (**9:30**) and percentages (**25%**) are **recognised** and get the right format automatically.

- **Del** opens the mini-menu: *content only*, *formatting only* or *everything*. **Backspace** clears the content, no questions asked.
- **Undo and redo** (**Ctrl** + **Z** / **Ctrl** + **Y**) cover everything: values, formats and even row/column operations.

Copy, paste and fill

- **Ctrl** + **C** / **X** / **V** with **styles and formulas**: pasted formulas shift their references (like Excel); Cut clears the source at paste time.
- The **fill handle** in the selection's corner drags series (1, 2, 3... / Mon, Tue...) and formulas; **double click** it to fill down as far as the neighbouring column.
- **Ctrl** + **D** fills down, **Ctrl** + **R** fills right.
- Drag the selection's **border** to move cells.

Formatting

- From the toolbar: **bold**, **italic**, **underline**, **strikethrough**, font size, text and fill colour, alignment.
- **Format cells**: per-side borders with style and colour, and number formats (currency, percentage, dates, times, decimals...).
- Ready-made **table styles**: solid header and banded rows in one click.
- Formatting applies to the selection only — and of course undoes with **Ctrl** + **Z**.

Rows, columns and data

- Right-click the headers to **insert or delete** rows and columns, several at a time too ("Delete 3 rows"). The sheet's formulas **shift by themselves**, with Excel's exact semantics.
- Double click a column edge = **auto-fit width** to content.
- **Sorting** ascending/descending, numeric and alphabetical.
- **Merge cells** from the toolbar.

CSV

.csv files open in the same grid, can be edited and saved; the Convert button turns them into real .xlsx when you need formulas and formatting.

Formulas

A real calculation engine: 342 functions, instant chained recalculation, English and Italian function names.

Writing a formula

Just like Excel: select the cell, type `=` and build. Function names are the standard English ones (`=SUM(A1:A5)`); Italian names are accepted too (`=SOMMA(A1:A5)` is the same formula — the file always stores the English name, exactly as Excel does, so the sheet opens anywhere). Both `,` and `;` work as argument separators.

- The **formula bar** at the top shows the cell's address and its true content.
- As you type, **autocomplete** suggests functions (`=SU` → SUM, SUBSTITUTE...).
- In **formula mode**, click a cell (or drag a range) to insert its reference: every reference is **colour-coded**, with a matching outline on the cell — you read the formula at a glance.
- `F4` cycles absolute references: `A1` → `$A$1` → `A$1` → `$A1` .
- Change a value and **every dependent formula updates**, in cascade and across sheets. Results are written into the file: anyone opening it with another app sees the right numbers.

Functions by category

Math 57

SUM SUMIF SUMIFS SUMPRODUCT SUMSQ SUMX2MY2 SUMX2PY2 SUMXMY2 ROUND ROUNDUP ROUNDDOWN TRUNC
INT ABS SQRT SQRTPI POWER MOD QUOTIENT EXP LN LOG LOG10 PI RAND RANDBETWEEN AGGREGATE
SUBTOTAL PRODUCT CEILING CEILING.MATH CEILING.PRECISE ISO.CEILING FLOOR FLOOR.MATH
FLOOR.PRECISE MROUND EVEN ODD SIGN GCD LCM FACT FACTDOUBLE COMBIN COMBINA MULTINOMIAL
DEGREES RADIANS ROMAN ARABIC BASE DECIMAL SERIESSUM MDETERM MMULT MUNIT

Statistics 24

AVERAGE AVERAGEA AVERAGEIF AVERAGEIFS MEDIAN MODE MAX MAXA MAXIFS MIN MINA MINIFS COUNT
COUNTA COUNTIF COUNTIFS COUNTBLANK LARGE SMALL RANK STDEV AVEDEV PERMUT PERMUTATIONA

Distributions & analysis 86

CORREL PEARSON RSQ SLOPE INTERCEPT STEYX TREND GROWTH LINEST LOGEST FORECAST
FORECAST.LINEAR FREQUENCY DEVSQ GEOMEAN HARMEAN TRIMMEAN KURT SKEW SKEW.P STANDARDIZE
PERCENTILE.INC PERCENTILE.EXC PERCENTRANK.INC PERCENTRANK.EXC QUARTILE.INC QUARTILE.EXC
RANK.EQ RANK.AVG MODE.SNGL MODE.MULT STDEV.S STDEV.P STDEVA STDEVPA VAR.S VAR.P VARA VARPA
COVARIANCE.P COVARIANCE.S CONFIDENCE.NORM CONFIDENCE.T PROB PHI GAUSS GAMMA GAMMALN
GAMMALN.PRECISE – and the distributions NORM.DIST NORM.INV NORM.S.DIST NORM.S.INV
LOGNORM.DIST LOGNORM.INV BINOM.DIST BINOM.DIST.RANGE BINOM.INV NEGBINOM.DIST POISSON.DIST
HYPGEOM.DIST EXPON.DIST BETA.DIST BETA.INV GAMMA.DIST GAMMA.INV WEIBULL.DIST CHISQ.DIST
CHISQ.DIST.RT CHISQ.INV CHISQ.INV.RT CHISQ.TEST T.DIST T.DIST.2T T.DIST.RT T.INV T.INV.2T
T.TEST F.DIST F.DIST.RT F.INV F.INV.RT F.TEST Z.TEST FISHER FISHERINV

Logic 11

IF IFS IFERROR IFNA AND OR NOT XOR SWITCH TRUE FALSE

Lookup & reference 14

VLOOKUP HLOOKUP LOOKUP MATCH INDEX CHOOSE UNIQUE ADDRESS AREAS ROW ROWS COLUMN COLUMNS
TRANSPOSE

Text 37

TEXT TEXTJOIN CONCATENATE CONCAT UPPER LOWER PROPER TRIM LEN LEFT RIGHT MID REPLACE
SUBSTITUTE FIND SEARCH REPT VALUE NUMBERTOVALUE EXACT FIXED DOLLAR CHAR CODE UNICHAR UNICODE
CLEAN T LEFTB RIGHTB MIDB LENB FINDB SEARCHB REPLACEB ASC BAHTTEXT DBCS

Date & time 25

TODAY NOW DATE DAY MONTH YEAR HOUR MINUTE SECOND DAYS WEEKDAY EOMONTH DATEDIF DATEVALUE
TIMEVALUE TIME EDATE WEEKNUM ISOWEEKNUM NETWORKDAYS NETWORKDAYS.INTL WORKDAY WORKDAY.INTL
YEARFRAC DAYS360

Information 14

ISBLANK ISNUMBER ISTEXT ISERROR ISERR ISNA ISEVEN ISLOGICAL ISNONTEXT ISREF ERROR.TYPE
TYPE N NA

Trigonometry 21

SIN COS TAN ASIN ACOS ATAN ATAN2 SINH COSH TANH ASINH ACOSH ATANH COT COTH ACOT ACOTH
SEC SECH CSC CSCH

Engineering 51

BIN2DEC BIN2HEX BIN2OCT DEC2BIN DEC2HEX DEC2OCT HEX2BIN HEX2DEC HEX2OCT OCT2BIN OCT2DEC
OCT2HEX BITAND BITOR BITXOR BITLSHIFT BITRSHIFT DELTA GESTEP ERF ERFC COMPLEX IMABS
IMAGINARY IMARGUMENT IMCONJUGATE IMCOS IMCOSH IMCOT IMCSC IMCSCH IMDIV IMEXP IMLN IMLOG10
IMLOG2 IMPOWER IMPRODUCT IMREAL IMSEC IMSECH IMSIN IMSINH IMSQRT IMSUB IMSUM IMTAN BESSELI
BESSELJ BESSELK BESSELY

Web 2

ENCODEURL WEBSERVICE

Current limits (stated honestly)

- **OFFSET** and **INDIRECT** are not recalculated live (they require dynamic references): the cell shows the value stored in the file.
- Excel 365's "dynamic array" functions (FILTER, SORT, SEQUENCE, LAMBDA...) are not available yet; UNIQUE exists in a basic form.
- If a sheet uses an unsupported function **nothing breaks**: the cell keeps the last value Excel calculated, and the file stays intact.

CHAPTER 10

Developer mode

One switch in the title bar turns Atelier into a technical workbench, without changing anything you already use.

Top right, next to the window controls, sits the **Standard / Developer** switch. In Developer a **bottom panel** appears with three tabs; drag its top edge to resize, click the active tab to collapse it. Nothing else in the app changes.

Code editor

Code files (`.ts` , `.js` , `.py` , `.json` , `.html` , `.css` , `.rs` ... over a hundred languages) open with **syntax highlighting**, **line numbers**, active-line marker, bracket matching, auto-indent and `Ctrl` + `F` search. The language is inferred from the extension and loaded only when needed. This works in *both* modes: code reads well in Standard too.

Running and previewing what you write

Two buttons in the editor bar, appearing only when they apply:

- **Run** on runnable files (`.py` , `.js` , `.ts` , `.ps1` , `.sh` , `.rb` , `.php` , `.go`): saves the file and launches it in the terminal, switching to Developer mode by itself. Output streams below.
- **Preview** on web files (`.html` , `.svg`): next to "Code" a "Preview" tab appears and shows the page as a browser would — stylesheets, scripts and relative images included. Save and the preview refreshes.

The preview runs *isolated*: your page's scripts work, but they cannot reach Atelier or your data.

You can of course type the command yourself in the terminal (`npm run dev` , `python script.py` , anything): the button is just the shortcut.

Terminal

A real terminal, opened in your vault folder. Type a command and press `Enter`: output streams in as it arrives, with errors in red and the exit code at the end.

- **Arrow keys** `↑↓` bring back commands you already ran.
- `cd` behaves as expected: the current folder sticks for the next command too (the prompt shows it).
- **Stop** (or `Ctrl + C`) kills a long-running command; `clear` or `Ctrl + L` wipes the screen.

For safety Atelier never launches arbitrary executables: it hands the command line to the system interpreter (PowerShell on Windows, sh on macOS), exactly like a terminal would.

Git

If your vault is a Git repository, the tab shows the **current branch** and every changed file, each with its label (*modified*, *new*, *deleted*, *renamed*). Click a file to see the **diff**, added lines in green and removed in red. At the bottom, the full round trip: **Stage all** → **Commit** → **Push**. If the folder isn't a repository yet, a button initialises one.

Tools

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
JSON	Format, minify and validate, pointing at the exact error when the text isn't valid JSON.
Regex	Try a regular expression against a text and see the matches highlighted, with a count.
Compare	Differs two texts line by line: what was removed and what was added.
Encode	Base64 and URL (both ways), SHA-256 digest, with one-click copy.

CHAPTER 11

Keyboard shortcuts

Everywhere

KEYS	ACTION
Ctrl + P	Quick file search by name
Ctrl + Shift + F	Global search inside file contents
Double click the title bar	Maximise / restore the window
Middle click on a tab	Closes the tab

In the spreadsheet

KEYS	ACTION
Arrow keys	Move the selection (confirming any pending edit)
Enter / Tab	Confirm and move down / right
F2 or double click	Edit the cell's content
Esc	Cancel the current edit
Ctrl + arrows	Jump to the edge of the data
Shift + click / Shift + arrows	Extend the selection
Ctrl + C / X / V	Copy / cut / paste (with styles and shifted formulas)
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y	Undo / redo (rows and columns included)
Ctrl + D / Ctrl + R	Fill down / right
Ctrl + F	Find in the sheet
F4 (in a formula)	Cycle absolute references (\$)
Del	Mini-menu: content / formatting / everything
Backspace	Clear the content
Double click a column edge	Auto-fit width
Double click the fill handle	Fill the formula all the way down

While presenting

KEYS	ACTION
Click · → · Space · Enter	Next slide
Right click · ← · Backspace	Previous slide
Esc	Leave the presentation

In code and the terminal

KEYS	ACTION
Ctrl + F	Search inside the open code file
Tab	Indent the line (or the selection)
↑ · ↓ in the terminal	Cycle through past commands
Ctrl + C in the terminal	Stop the running command
Ctrl + L in the terminal	Clear the screen

CHAPTER 12

Frequently asked questions

Where are my files?

In the vault folder, as normal files. You can open them, copy them and back them up with the tools you already use. Atelier doesn't convert them and doesn't hide them in any database.

Do I need an internet connection?

No. Everything — editing, formulas, OCR, conversions — happens on your computer.

What if I delete a file by mistake?

It's in the vault's Trash (the `.atelier` folder): recover it from there.

Can I open Atelier's files with other apps?

Always: `.docx`, `.xlsx`, `.pdf` and images remain 100% standard files. Notes are Markdown text, readable everywhere.

Will Excel reopen the sheets I edit correctly?

Yes: Atelier preserves the file's entire content, including the parts it doesn't display (e.g. charts). Formulas are stored with their standard names and up-to-date results.

What about PowerPoint presentations?

.pptx files open in a faithful viewer (shapes, text, images, SmartArt) with thumbnails in the sidebar, zoom, and a **Present** button for full screen — click or right arrow to advance, left arrow to go back, **Esc** to leave. Declared **transitions** are played. Presentations are read-only by design: Atelier shows and presents them, it doesn't edit them.

What's still missing?

Spreadsheet charts are shown but can't be created from Atelier, and some Excel 365 dynamic functions aren't supported (see chapter 9).